

MATTHEW GISSENTANNA

Geospatial Analyst | Part 107 Drone Pilot | Builds AI-Powered Tooling with Claude Code

Brighton, CO | matt@gissentanna.com | linkedin.com/in/matthewgissentanna | @mattecruiser

WHY I'M YOUR CANDIDATE FOR THE OFFROAD VERTICAL

- **I am the customer.** Active overlander building a 2024 Toyota LC250 documented at @mattecruiser; firsthand navigation of trail networks, terrain data, and BLM/USFS land-access content across the western US.
- **I ship with Claude Code.** Built two full-stack internal tools end to end (frontend, backend, database) using Claude Code as a daily co-pilot — exactly the AI-augmented workflow this role asks for.
- **I run the full geospatial stack.** FAA Part 107 pilot operating DJI Matrice 4E (RTK), processing imagery in Pix4D, building deliverables in ArcGIS Pro, and actively studying GIS and UAS at the University of Denver.
- **I bring senior judgment, not just senior years.** 18+ years leading complex data pipelines, QA systems, and cross-functional execution at Amazon and Rubrik — equivalent technical experience this role explicitly invites.

AI-AUGMENTED DEVELOPMENT

- **Built two full-stack internal tools (frontend + backend + database)** as a solo developer using Claude Code, including iterative architecture decisions, API design, schema modeling, and deployment.
- Use Claude Code daily to generate, refactor, and automate Python scripts for geospatial workflows including feature extraction, data validation, and metadata processing.
- Apply prompt engineering and AI judgment to balance speed with code quality — pairing model output with human validation rather than accepting generated code blindly.

CORE COMPETENCIES

GIS and Geospatial: ArcGIS Pro (primary), Pix4D (PIX4Dmatic), QGIS (familiarity), Global Mapper, Multi-Source Data Integration, Conflation, Feature Extraction, Classification, Large-Scale QA/QC, Dataset Audits and Refreshes, Shapefile and GeoJSON Workflows, Coordinate Reference Systems, Geospatial Metadata

Programming and Pipelines: Python, SQL, GDAL (familiarity), geopandas (familiarity), Data Pipeline Design, Automated Data Processing, API Integration, Version Control (Git, GitHub), Full-Stack App Development

Remote Sensing and UAS: FAA Part 107, Aerial Imagery Acquisition, Photogrammetry, LiDAR Data Processing, RTK / GPS / GNSS, Ground Control Points (GCPs), DJI Matrice 4E (RTK)

Cloud and Collaboration: AWS, Distributed/Remote Workflows, Jira, Confluence, GitHub, Microsoft Office Suite, Adobe Creative Suite

Domain Expertise: Off-Road Recreation, Trail Networks, Overland Route Planning, Terrain Navigation, Public Lands Access (BLM, USFS, State Lands)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder / Geospatial Analyst and UAS Pilot — Liquid Sun Creative
Brighton, CO

2021 – Present

- Build and validate geospatial datasets from drone-acquired imagery using ArcGIS Pro and Pix4D — feature extraction, digitization, classification, and shapefile export with proper coordinate reference systems and attribute schemas.
- Execute large-scale QA/QC across photogrammetry deliverables; analyze quality reports, resolve multi-block calibration issues, and surface data quality risks before client delivery.
- Plan and fly drone mapping missions with DJI Matrice 4E (RTK), including RTK/GNSS ground control setup and flight planning across complex terrain.
- Research and evaluate open-source geospatial sources (USGS, OpenStreetMap, NAIP, BLM, USFS) for fitness, licensing, and quality.
- Maintain version control across geospatial scripts and project deliverables; document standards and metadata for client transparency.

Senior Technical Program Manager — Amazon (AWS and Devices)

Jul 2022 – Jan 2026

Denver, CO

- Designed and automated end-to-end data processing pipelines transforming 200+ raw data points into actionable QBR reports across distributed teams.
- Built CVE tracking and QA systems that improved remediation efficiency by 50% and reduced processing backlog by 80%, with dashboards monitoring data health metrics.
- Led complex multi-source data integration and cleanup across 400+ stakeholders, applying technical judgment to resolve ambiguity and edge cases.
- Owned end-to-end delivery from intake through production release and post-launch validation; ran end-of-life OS program to 95% on-time completion.
- Communicated technical decisions, risks, and progress to Directors and VPs; translated complex findings for non-technical partners.

Project Manager – Professional Services — Rubrik

May 2021 – Jul 2022

Palo Alto, CA (Remote)

- Led two of the largest deployments in company history (\$10M+ budgets, 200+ team members) in a fully distributed environment, increasing project efficiency by 35% and on-time delivery by 20%.

Earlier Career: IT Supervisor at Synovus Financial (Jira CoE administration, cross-functional leadership); Scrum Master and Business Systems Analyst roles at Omega Financial, Delta Data Software, and Aflac (2007–2018).

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

University of Denver

Sep 2025 – Mar 2027

Graduate Certificate in GIS and Unmanned Aircraft Systems (In Progress)

Coursework: Cartography and Map Design, GIS Fundamentals, Remote Sensing, UAS Operations, Geospatial Data Analysis, Photogrammetry

Troy University

2010 – 2019

B.S. in Business Administration – Global Business

Certifications: FAA Part 107 Remote Pilot (Current) | PMP – PMI (2017) | Certified ScrumMaster – Scrum Alliance (2015) | CompTIA Server+ (2014)

ADDITIONAL

- Board President, Foundations Academy (NHA Charter School) – Brighton, CO.

- Comfortable in distributed and remote-first environments; passionate about land stewardship and recreational access.